DATA VISUALIZATION & STORYTELLING

Sample Superstore | A data-led review of sales and profitability

Central business question: Where should the business focus to grow sales while protecting profit?

TOTAL SALES	TOTAL PROFIT	PROFIT MARGIN	ORDER-LINE RECORDS
$2,296,195.59	**$286,241.42**	**12.5%**	**9,977**

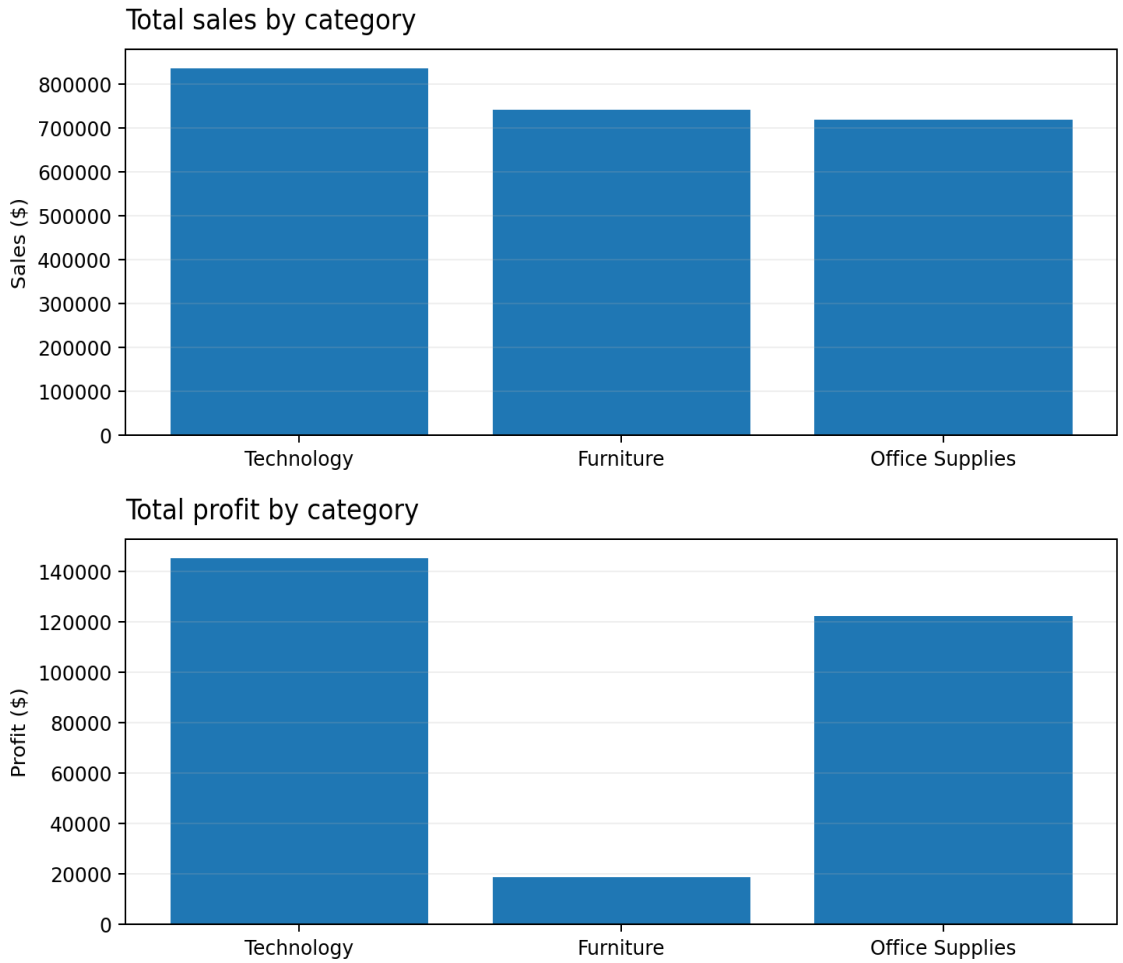
Executive summary

The dataset contains 9,977 usable records across 3 product categories, 4 regions and 3 customer segments. Technology contributes the largest share of sales (36.4%), while Technology generates the highest category profit. 1,869 records (18.7%) have negative profit, so a sales-only strategy could hide important losses.

Story arc: establish performance → compare categories and regions → find profit risks → recommend focused action.

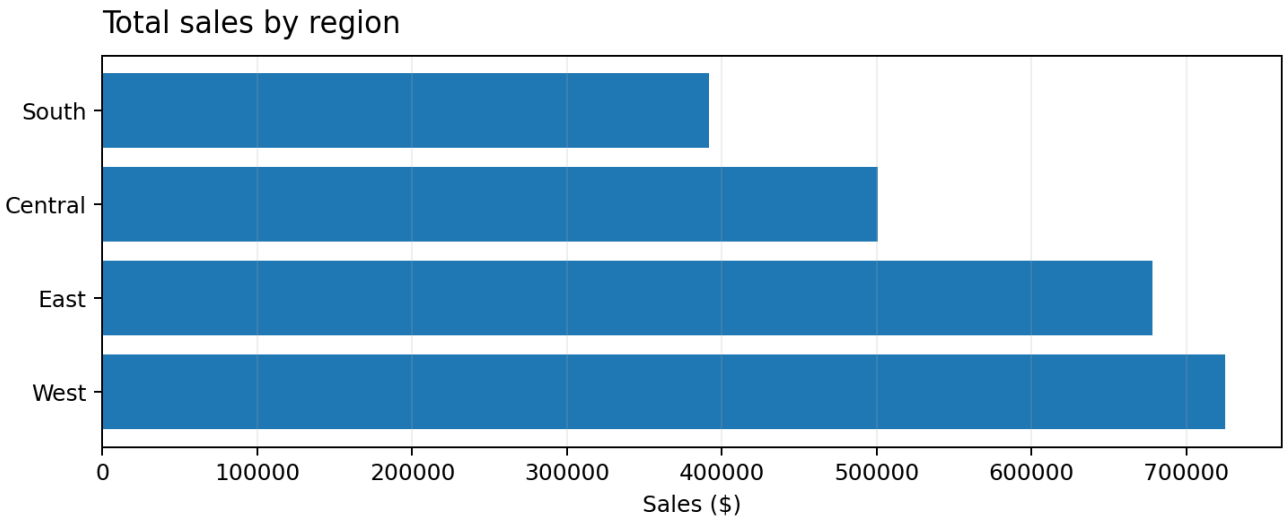
Dataset note: the supplied CSV has no Order Date column, so this report does not claim a monthly or seasonal sales trend. All metrics and charts in this report are calculated from the uploaded file.

1. Category performance: sales are only half the story



Takeaway: Technology is the largest sales category, and Technology leads on total profit. Compare both metrics together before deciding where to invest.

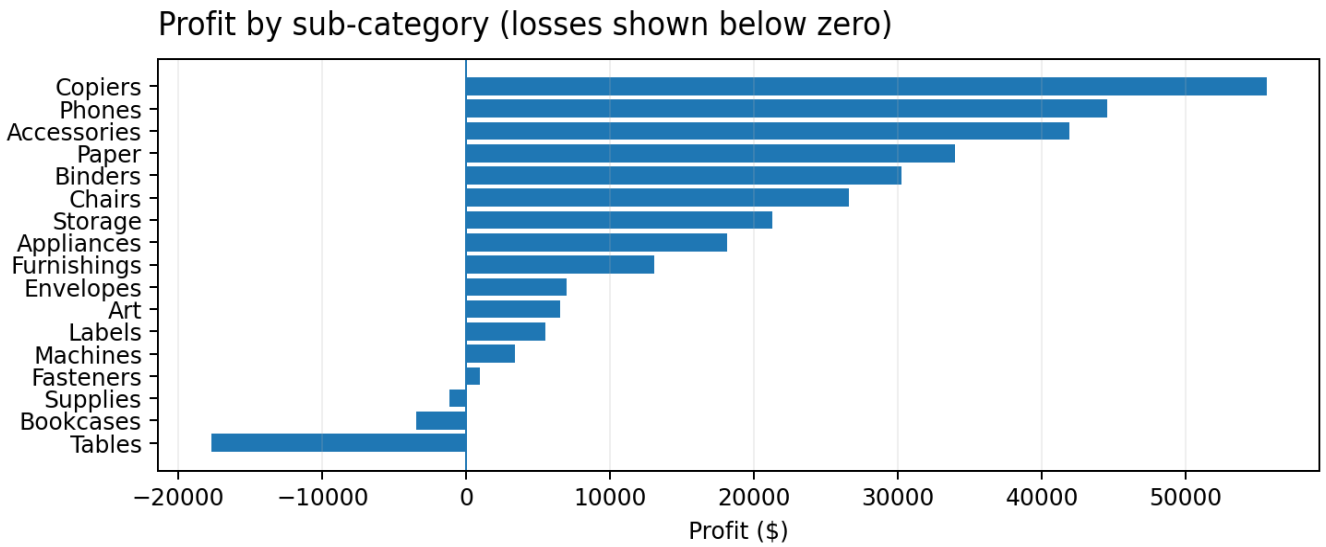
2. Regional performance: compare market size and return



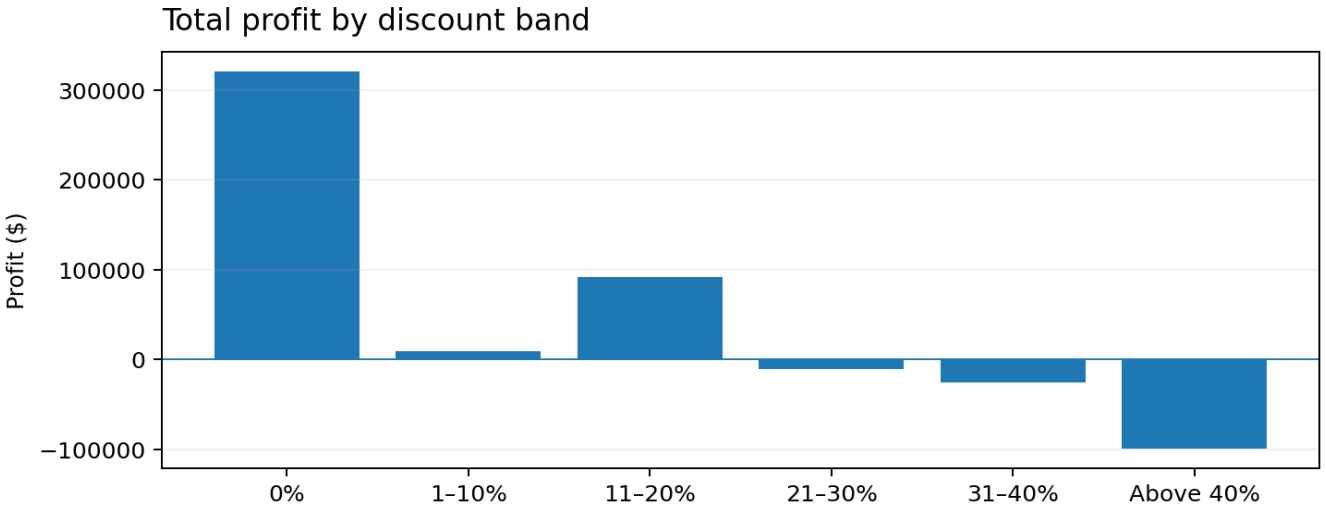
Takeaway: West has the highest regional sales, while South has the lowest. This identifies a difference in revenue scale—not by itself a difference in efficiency.

Recommended follow-up: calculate profit margin by region and compare product mix, discounting and shipping mode before reallocating sales or marketing resources.

3. Profit risk: inspect loss-making products and discounts

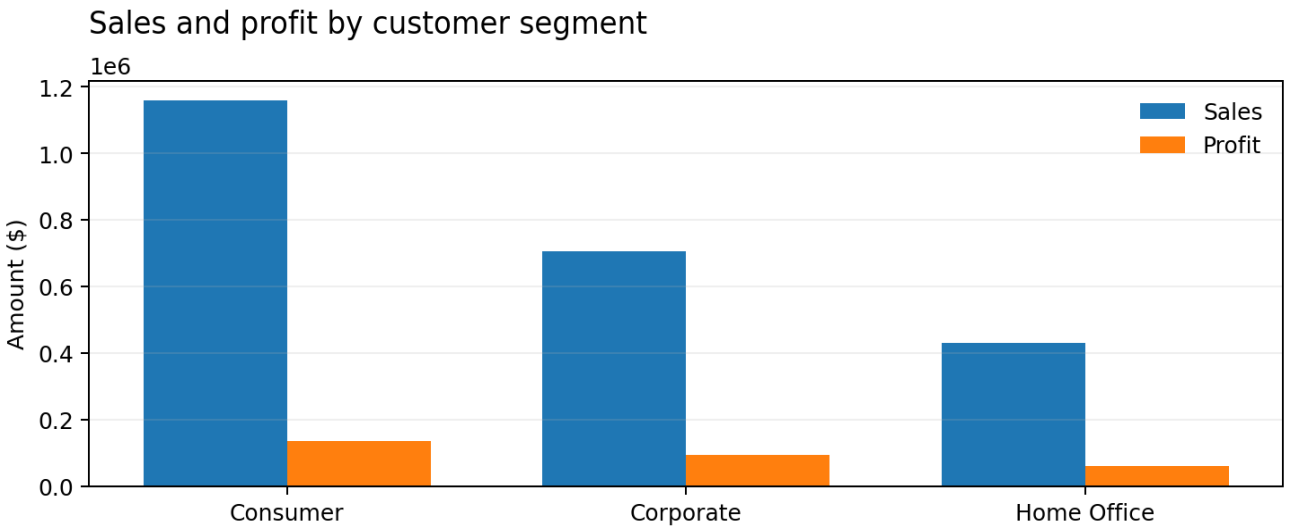


Takeaway: Tables has the lowest total profit ($-17,725.48); 3 sub-categories have negative total profit.



Data signal: the record-level correlation between discount and profit is -0.22. This is an association, not proof that discounting alone causes lower profit. Review the actual profit by discount band and product group.

4. Customer segments and recommended actions



Takeaway: The segment comparison shows where revenue and profit are concentrated. A segment with high sales but relatively weak profit should be reviewed for discount and product mix.

Recommended actions

1. Track profit and profit margin alongside sales in every category and region.
2. Review loss-making sub-categories and inspect the underlying orders before changing pricing or assortment.
3. Set discount guardrails based on product-level profitability; avoid assuming one discount rule fits all products.
4. Compare customer segments using both sales and profit, then target campaigns where returns are strongest.
5. Add an Order Date field or use a version of the dataset that includes dates if a monthly trend analysis is required.

Conclusion: Prioritize profitable growth: expand what performs well, investigate persistent losses, and evaluate decisions using profit—not sales alone.

Appendix: key figures and methodology

Category summary

Category	Sales	Profit	Profit margin
Technology	$836,154.03	$145,454.95	17.4%
Furniture	$741,306.31	$18,421.81	2.5%
Office Supplies	$718,735.24	$122,364.66	17.0%

Method

Sales and profit are summed from the numeric Sales and Profit columns. Profit margin is total profit divided by total sales. Discount bands group the numeric Discount field; negative-profit records are counted where Profit is below zero. All charts are generated directly from the uploaded CSV after removing rows with missing or non-numeric values in Sales, Quantity, Discount or Profit.

Limitations

The supplied dataset has no Order Date field, so temporal trends cannot be analyzed from this file. Correlation between discount and profit is descriptive and does not establish causation. Results may vary if the dataset is updated or filtered.

Source: SampleSuperstore_data_set.csv provided for this task.